

English News Hub | Lesson Worksheet

Part 1: Discussion — Big Events

1. Which of these types of "big events" have you been to?
 - Sports match
 - Concert
 - National celebration
 - Festival
2. Why do people enjoy attending these types of events?

Part 2: Before We Read — Vocabulary Focus

Match the words on the left with their correct meanings on the right:

- | | |
|-----------------------------------|---|
| 1. Gathered | A. Happening outside, not inside a building |
| 2. Open-air | B. Getting what you want straight away, not waiting |
| 3. Immediate gratification | C. Came together in the same place, usually as a group |
| 4. Sermon | D. Made people interested enough to attend or participate |
| 5. Attracted | E. A speech by a religious leader |
| 6. Dignity | F. A strong feeling of excitement and interest |
| 7. Enthusiasm | G. The feeling of being respected and valued |
| 8. Atmosphere | H. The feeling or mood of a place or situation |

Part 3: Reading Text Pope-mania grips Paris Date: 26th September 2026

Around 800,000 people gathered in Paris on Saturday to see Pope Leo XIV celebrate a huge open-air Mass at the Place de la Concorde. The crowd, many waving French and Vatican flags, stretched along the Champs-Élysées.

The Mass was the main event of the Pope's four-day visit to France. During his sermon, he warned people about material goods and immediate gratification, saying that modern life can leave people feeling empty. Speaking directly to young people, he told them: *"You are the Church today."*

The event attracted people from across France and other countries. Some had travelled long distances to be there. One young man even arrived from London at 3am because it was his birthday and he did not want to miss the Mass.

The Pope's visit also attracted several important French politicians and former presidents. He had earlier met migrants and spoke about the importance of living together in dignity and peace.

The huge crowds and enthusiasm have led some observers to compare the atmosphere with Pope John Paul II's visits to France decades ago.

(Article adapted from The Daily Telegraph)

Part 4: Reading Comprehension

Check your understanding of the article:

1. How many people gathered to see the Pope in Paris?
2. The Pope said “you are the church,” to whom?
3. The article mentions a man from London; what time did he arrive in Paris?
4. The Pope spoke to migrants about living in dignity and _____.

Part 5: Discussion & Critical Thinking

- **Discussion:** Do you think all 800,000 people are strict Catholics? If not, why did they want to go to this event?
- **Situation:** You are at a huge event. You have a perfect view, and professional cameras are filming everything. Why do you still take out your phone and record it?
- **Hot Take:** *"People are more interested in proving they were there than actually enjoying the experience."* Do you agree?

Part 6: Final Task — The Debate

Choose a side of the argument for one of the topics below and defend it.

- **Topic 1:** Mobile phones should be banned from sports events and concerts.
- **Topic 2:** People only go to big events because they want to feel part of something.

Useful Opinion Phrases:

- I get what you mean, but...
- I see it differently to you...
- As far as I'm concerned...
- I strongly believe...